



Bazaar

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SATA

A serial interconnect system between motherboards and peripherals

80% of netbook buyers consider them secondary PCs



Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computer niggles and nags are dealt with here!

Monitor doesn't display anything

I read the QnA and Agent001 section in Digit regularly, and so I'm writing to you with my problem. My system is an Intel Core 2 Duo E4500, 250-GB HDD, GeForce 8600GT 512 MB and 4 GB 800-MHz RAM. I use an HCL 7005FI monitor. I installed *Left 4 Dead* without any hassles, and it runs properly. However, my monitor doesn't show me any display. Instead, it gives a message with a blank screen - HF 70 Hz and management in 15 sec. Please give me a solution to this problem.

Harsimranjit Singh Rangri

A The problem is with your monitor and your game settings. The game loads with a resolution or a frequency that isn't supported by your monitor. To fix this, right-click on the game in your Steam list of games and then on Properties. Click on Set Launch Options. Enter the value as -w 800. This will force the game to load with a resolution of 800 x 600. You can also try setting your monitor refresh rate for Windows to something a bit lower.

Query for a TA790GX3-A2 motherboard

I recently got a computer assembled by a local computer vendor in Baroda, Gujarat. The specification of my PC is as follows: AMD Phenom Quad Core 9950+ with a Biostar TA790GX3 motherboard 2 x 2 GB Transcend 800 MHz FSB DDR2 RAM

The rest of the system has regular components. I have a few queries regarding the products. Why can't I run both the modules in dual-channel mode even if they are both of the same frequency? I have lost my installation CD. Can you help me to source a new one?

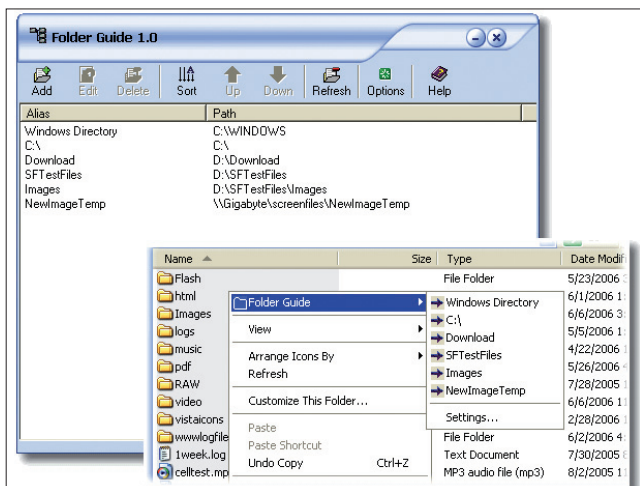
Pankaj

A The problems with dual-channel mode could be a compatibility problem between your memory and the motherboard. It could be that the RAM modules are plugged into the wrong slots. The drivers for your motherboard can be found at Biostar's site - http://www.biostar.com.tw/app/en-us/t-series/driver.php?S_ID=376.

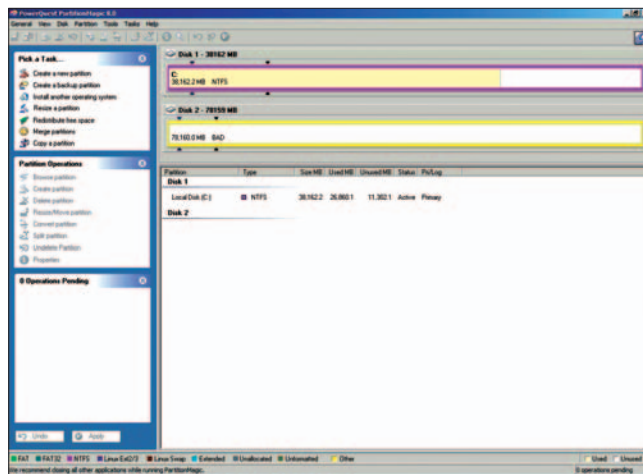
A few problems

1. Can I customise the right-click menu? I know how to do this from the Registry Editor. How can we add a folder name in the list of the right-click menu?

2. I have a computer running Windows XP with 512 MB of RAM. It was recently formatted because of some virus. Before formatting, *GTA Vice City* ran smoothly, but now it shows the error "Cannot find video mem-



Folder Guide lets you easily add folders to the right-click menu



Partition Magic is a well known commercial partitioning utility

ory". I had manually increased the video memory from the Windows Control Panel, but the game still does not start. What should I do?

3. Tell me how I can merge two Windows partitions or remove the partitions?

4. Also, tell me how you get 8 GB in a DVD of capacity 4.7 GB?

Akshay Soam

A Although you can use the Registry Editor to add the specified entry, it might be easier to use software to do this - <http://www.freeware365.com/desktop/folderguide.htm>.

If you run a computer with an onboard graphics card, then that is the cause of your problem. Try increasing the allotted-memory to your onboard graphics solution from the BIOS.- Upgrading your system or installing a graphics card is highly recommended.

You can remove Windows partitions from the Computer Management utility under Administrative Tools in the Control Panel. Go to Disk Management and right-click on the partitions you want to delete. The partition you are currently working on cannot be deleted though. Merging can be done by first moving all data from one partition to the other, and then expanding that partition. You can also look for commercial partitioning utilities such as Partition Magic and EASEUS Partition Manager.

8 GB can only be burnt on dual-layer DVDs. These are different from single-layer DVDs that we find everywhere. 8 GB dual-layer DVDs are expensive and usually cost around Rs. 100 per disc.

Windows installation won't detect my hard drive

My one-year old PC with an Intel DG33BU board, an Intel Core 2 Duo E4500 processor, a 160 GB Seagate SATA hard drive, a Lite-On DVD Writer and 3 GB DDR2 RAM (512+512, 1+1 GB, dual channel), does not run with SATA hard disk. Windows fails to detect the hard disk during its installation. When I set the 'ATA/IDE mode' to 'Native' and 'SATA Configuration' to either 'IDE' or 'AHCI' in BIOS, I am forced to set the 'ATA/IDE mode' to 'Legacy'. As a result, the 'SATA Configuration' option in BIOS is disabled. Only then am I able to install Windows. Although it has been running fine since then with the setting, I think I may not be getting the optimum speed of SATA drives. I have seen my friend's PC with a 965 chipset-based motherboard running fine with 'Native' SATA support. Suggest what to do.

Anupom Bora